Dinosaur Poster

U02 / S02.3

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

THE JOB

Pick one dinosaur that lived in the Mesozoic Era, during the Triassic, Jurassic, or Cretaceous Period, and make a colored infographic poster about it. An infographic tells its story with pictures, a map, and short labels, not paragraphs. Page 2 is a menu of dinosaurs with the facts you'll need. Page 3 is the outline. This one is an individual project.

WHAT GOES ON THE POSTER

1. **Name header.** Your dinosaur's name across the top, big enough to read from across the room.
2. **Mesozoic timeline.** A strip with three boxes: Triassic (252 to 201 mya), Jurassic (201 to 145 mya), and Cretaceous (145 to 66 mya). Mark when your dinosaur lived. mya means million years ago.
3. **Drawing.** A big drawing of your dinosaur. Tracing is fine.
4. **About My Dinosaur.** Eight facts, picked from the list on page 2: period, hip type, diet, habitat, what it walked on, size, special feature, and where its fossils were found.
5. **Map.** Earth the way it looked when your dinosaur was alive, not today's map. Put a dot on every place its fossils have been found, and add a key that says what the dots mean.
6. **Color.** The whole poster is in color, not pencil or pen alone.

LIZARD-HIPPED OR BIRD-HIPPED

Scientists sort dinosaurs into two groups by the shape of their hip bones. Your poster has to say which group yours is in.

Saurischian

MEANS LIZARD-HIPPED

In most of them, one hip bone (the pubis) points forward and down, like a lizard's. The meat-eaters like T. rex, Velociraptor, and Spinosaurus are in this group, and so are the long-necked plant-eaters like Brachiosaurus.

Ornithischian

MEANS BIRD-HIPPED

The pubis points backward, like a bird's. Every dinosaur in this group ate plants. Stegosaurus, Triceratops, and Ankylosaurus are bird-hipped.

The names are backwards from what you'd guess. Birds come from the lizard-hipped group, not the bird-hipped one. Their ancestors were small meat-eating dinosaurs.

The rubric is on page 4. Check your poster against it before you turn it in.

The Menu: 15 Dinosaurs

mya means million years ago. Dates and lengths are approximate. Lengths are in meters. The states are all in the USA. Oldest period at the top.

DINOSAUR	PART	MYA	HIP	DIET	WALKS ON	LENGTH (M)	FOSSILS FOUND IN	NAME MEANS
TRIASSIC PERIOD · 252 TO 201 MYA								
Herrerasaurus	Late	231	Lizard	Carnivore	2	3 to 6	Argentina	
Eoraptor	Late	231 to 228	Lizard	Carnivore, maybe omnivore	2	about 1	Argentina	dawn thief
Plateosaurus	Late	214 to 204	Lizard	Herbivore	2	5 to 10	Germany, Switzerland, France	probably “broad lizard”
Liliensternus	Late	uncertain	Lizard	Carnivore	2	about 5	Germany	
Coelophysis	Late	206 to 201	Lizard	Carnivore	2	2 to 3	New Mexico	
JURASSIC PERIOD · 201 TO 145 MYA								
Dilophosaurus	Early	196 to 183	Lizard	Carnivore	2	6 to 7	Arizona	two-crested lizard
Allosaurus	Late	155 to 147	Lizard	Carnivore	2	about 8.5	Colorado, Utah, Wyoming. Portugal	
Stegosaurus	Late	155 to 150	Bird	Herbivore	4	7 to 9	Colorado, Utah, Wyoming. Portugal	roof lizard
Diplodocus	Late	155 to 147	Lizard	Herbivore	4	24 to 26	Colorado, Utah, Wyoming, Montana	double beam
Brachiosaurus	Late	154 to 153	Lizard	Herbivore	4	18 to 22	Colorado, Utah, Wyoming, Oklahoma	arm lizard
CRETACEOUS PERIOD · 145 TO 66 MYA								
Spinosaurus	Middle	100 to 94	Lizard	Fish-eater	2	12 to 15	Egypt, Morocco. Niger (a second species, named 2026)	spine lizard
Velociraptor	Late	75 to 71	Lizard	Carnivore	2	1.5 to 2	Mongolia, China	swift thief
Tyrannosaurus rex	Late	68 to 66	Lizard	Carnivore	2	12 to 13	Montana, South Dakota, Wyoming. Canada: Saskatchewan	tyrant lizard king
Triceratops	Late	68 to 66	Bird	Herbivore	4	7 to 9	Montana, North Dakota, South Dakota, Wyoming. Canada: Alberta, Saskatchewan	three-horned face
Ankylosaurus	Late	68 to 66	Bird	Herbivore	4	6 to 8	Montana, Wyoming. Canada: Alberta	fused lizard

You can pick a dinosaur that isn't on the menu if it lived in the Mesozoic, but you'll have to find its facts yourself. Pterosaurs, plesiosaurs, ichthyosaurs, and mosasaurs aren't dinosaurs.

ABOUT MY DINOSAUR · PICK ONE ANSWER FOR EACH

- **Period:** Early, Middle, or Late, plus Triassic, Jurassic, or Cretaceous. For example, Late Jurassic.
- **Hip type:** lizard-hipped (saurischian) or bird-hipped (ornithischian)
- **Diet:** carnivore (meat), herbivore (plants), omnivore (both), or fish-eater
- **Habitat:** forest, river floodplain, coastal plain, swamp or wetland, desert dunes, or open woodland. It isn't on the menu, so look it up.
- **Walks on:** 2 legs, 4 legs, or both
- **Size:** length in meters, next to a school bus (about 12 m). A 24 m dinosaur is about 2 buses long.
- **Special feature:** horns, frill, armor, plates or spikes, claws, crest, feathers, speed, or size
- **Fossils found in:** the countries or states. These become the dots on your map.

POSTER OUTLINE

What Goes Where

Your poster needs every zone on this page. Where the zones sit is up to you.

NAME HEADER

your dinosaur's name, big

MESOZOIC TIMELINE

mark when your dinosaur lived

TRIASSIC	JURASSIC	CRETACEOUS
252 to 201 mya	201 to 145 mya	145 to 66 mya

OLDER YOUNGER

DRAWING

your dinosaur, big. Tracing is fine.

ABOUT MY DINOSAUR

one answer for each, from the list on page 2

Period

Hip type

Diet

Habitat

Walks on

Size (m, and buses)

Special feature

Fossils found in

MAP OF EARTH BACK THEN

the continents where they were when your dinosaur lived

● fossil site

COLOR: the whole poster, every zone.

Solid teal border: facts. Dashed black border: pictures.

My Plan and Rubric

MY PLAN

Fill this in before you start the poster.

My dinosaur _____

Period (Early, Middle, or Late, and which period) _____

Hip type _____

Fossils found in (countries or states) _____

_____

Where I got my picture (website or book) _____

_____

RUBRIC · 20 POINTS

PART	FULL CREDIT	PARTIAL	LITTLE OR NONE	SCORE
Name header 2 points	2. Dinosaur's name across the top, spelled right and big enough to read from across the room.	1. Name is there but small or misspelled.	0. No name.	☐
Timeline 3 points	3. Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous with their dates. When your dinosaur lived is marked in the right period.	1 to 2. A period or its dates are missing, or the mark is in the wrong place.	0. No timeline.	☐
Drawing 3 points	3. A big, clear drawing of your dinosaur. Tracing is fine.	1 to 2. Small, unfinished, or hard to tell what it is.	0. No drawing.	☐
About My Dinosaur 5 points	5. All 8 facts, and they're correct: period, hip type, diet, habitat, walks on, size compared with a school bus, special feature, fossils found in.	2 to 4. Some facts are missing or wrong.	0 to 1. One or two facts, or none.	☐
Map & fossil dots 4 points	4. Earth when your dinosaur lived, not today's map. A dot on each place its fossils were found, and a key for the dots.	2 to 3. Today's map, or dots missing or in the wrong places.	0 to 1. No map, or a map with no dots.	☐
Clear, visual, color 3 points	3. Pictures and short labels, no paragraphs. The whole poster is colored and readable from a few feet away.	1 to 2. Too much writing, or only parts are colored.	0. Mostly paragraphs, or mostly black and white.	☐

TOTAL ☐ **/ 20**